

The Credit Shakedown

"She works hard for the money, so hard for it, honey. She works hard for the money so you better treat her right."

~ Donna Summer

Let me give you some interesting big number statistics to throw out at your next neighborhood barbecue:

- ✓ By the end of 2003, there were nearly 1.3 billion credit cards in circulation in the United States.
- ✓ We Americans spend approximately \$1.5 trillion using our credit cards.
- ✓ America's credit card use is greater than the rest of the entire world combined.
- ✓ Among U.S. industries, none draws higher profits than the credit card industry.
- ✓ Credit card banks were top contributors to President Bush's 2000 election campaign. MBNA ranked #1, the largest donor; Citigroup, #10, and Bank of America, #13.
- ✓ The MBNA president personally gave \$100,000 to the Bush fund.
- ✓ MBNA dropped to #6 for the 2004 Bush campaign, but gave more money – more than \$350,000.